Physiotherapy: Broken Ribs

You have been given this information because you have been diagnosed with broken ribs. Your rib injuries should heal themselves, though this may take as long as two or three months. You may experience significant pain and this may increase for the first few days after your injury.

The importance of deep breathing and coughing exercises with broken ribs:

Most problems after breaking your ribs will relate to your lungs. Due to pain around your chest, your breathing may be shallow, and your cough may be weak. This can cause phlegm to build up in the lungs, which can lead to a chest infection or pneumonia. You will be advised to do deep breathing exercises (see below) by your medical team, nursing team or physiotherapist. Please do these exercises regularly to minimise the risk of you getting a chest infection.

Breathing exercises

- Carry out your breathing exercises each waking hour throughout your hospital stay.
- Your nurse or physiotherapist will show you the positions in which to do the exercises. This will usually be sitting, in the upright position if your other injuries allow this.
- Breathe slowly in through your nose and out through your mouth. Breathe in fully, drawing air to the bottom of your lungs. **Do this six times, holding every third breath for five seconds.**
- Cough deeply from your stomach to your throat.
- You may or may not cough up some phlegm.
- If you cough up some phlegm spit it into a pot or tissue and repeat the cycle until you are no longer coughing up any phlegm.
- **Repeat the exercises every waking hour.**
- If pain is preventing you from performing these exercises regularly, do inform your nurse so that you receive the right amount and type of pain relief.

Walking (under guidance from your medical team/ nursing team/ physiotherapist)

When your condition allows, nursing staff or the physiotherapist will help you to sit in a chair and to walk. This may be on the day of your hospital admission. You may have oxygen, drips and drains attached but this should not stop you getting out of bed with support from staff.
Once your ability to sit out in a chair and walk on the ward by yourself has been assessed, aim to sit out at regular intervals and complete regular short walks throughout the day. Gradually increase the distance as you are able. If you have any concerns or queries regarding your exercises then please ask your nurse/ physiotherapist for advice.

Ffisiotherapi: Torasgwrn Asennau

Rydych wedi derbyn yr wybodaeth hon oherwydd eich bod wedi derbyn diagnosis o dorasgwrn asennau. Dylai'ch anaf i'r asennau wella ei hunain, ond gall hyn gymryd hyd at 2-3 mis. Mae'n bosibl byddwch yn cael dipyn o boen, a gall hyn gynyddu am yr ychydig ddyddiau cyntaf ar ôl eich anaf.

Pwysigrwydd ymarferion anadlu dwfn a pheswch gyda thorasgwrn asennau:

Bydd y rhan fwyaf o broblemau yn dilyn torasgwrn asennau yn ymwneud â'ch ysgyfaint. Oherwydd y boen o gwmpas eich brest, mae'n bosibl bydd eich anadlu'n ysgafn, a bydd eich peswch yn wan. Gall hyn achosi i fflem adeiladu yn yr ysgyfaint, a all arwain at haint y frest neu niwmonia. Fe'ch cynghorir i ymgymryd ag ymarferion anadlu'n ddwfn (gweler isod) gan eich tîm meddygol, tîm nyrsio neu ffisiotherapydd. Dylech wneud yr ymarferion hyn yn rheolaidd i leihau'r risg o haint ar y frest.

Ymarferion anadlu

- Dylech wneud eich ymarferion anadlu bob awr y byddwch yn effro drwy gydol eich arhosiad ysbyty.
- Bydd eich nyrs neu ffisiotherapydd yn dangos y gwahanol osgo dylech eu defnyddio i wneud yr ymarferion. Fel arfer bydd y rhain yn cynnwys eistedd, ar osgo syth, os bydd eich anafiadau eraill yn eich caniatáu i wneud hyn.
- Anadlwch yn araf drwy eich trwyn ac allan drwy eich ceg. Anadlwch yn llawn, gan dynnu'r anadl i waelod eich ysgyfaint. **Gwnewch hyn chwe gwaith, gan ddal bob trydydd anadl am bum eiliad.**
- Dylech beswch yn ddwfn o'ch stumog i'ch gwddf.
- Mae'n bosibl byddwch yn peswch ychydig o fflem, neu efallai ddim.
- Os byddwch yn peswch fflem, dylech ei boeri i botyn neu hances bapur, ailadroddwch y cylch hyd nes na fyddwch yn peswch unrhyw fflem.
- **Ailadroddwch yr ymarferiad bob awr byddwch yn effro.**
- Os yw'r boen yn eich rhwystro rhag perfformio'r ymarferion rhain yn rheolaidd, rhowch wybod i'ch nyrs fel eich bod yn derbyn y dos a'r math o boen laddwr cywir.

Cerdded (gan ddefnyddio canllawiau eich tîm meddygol/tîm nyrsio/ffisiotherapydd)

Pan fydd eich cyflwr yn eich galluogi, bydd y staff nyrsio neu'r ffisiotherapydd yn eich helpu i eistedd ar gadair a cherdded. Efallai bydd hyn yn digwydd ar ddiwrnod eich derbyn i'r ysbyty. Efallai byddwch yn cael ocsigen a bydd dripiau a draeniau wedi'u cysylltu arnoch, ond ni ddylai hyn eich rhwystro rhag codi o'r gwely gyda chefnogaeth gan staff.
Pan fydd eich gallu i eistedd ar gadair a cherdded ar y ward heb gymorth wedi'u hasesu, anelwch i eistedd allan a mynd am dro bach yn rheolaidd drwy gydol y dydd. Yn raddol, cynyddwch y pellter. Os bydd gennych unrhyw bryderon neu ymholiadau ynghylch eich ymarferion, gofynnwch i'ch nyrs/ffisiotherapydd am gyngor.